



CAUSATIVES AND PERMISSIVES

A Primer

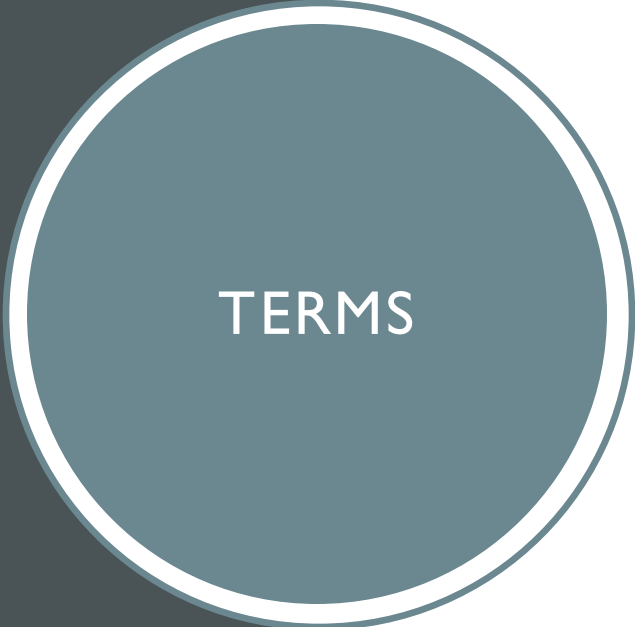


DEFINITION

- We use causatives and permissives when the subject of a sentence does not do an action but rather causes or permits another agent to do an action.
- For example, whenever you want, have, allow someone to do something, you are using a causative or permissive.

Usamos las **formas causativas y permisivas** cuando el sujeto de una oración **no realiza una acción directamente**, sino que **hace que otro agente la realice o le permite hacerlo**.

- Por ejemplo, cada vez que **quieres, haces o permites** que alguien haga algo, estás usando una **forma causativa o permisiva**.



TERMS

- **Subject:** The person who initiates the action.
 - **Main** (or functional) verb: The verb that gets conjugated (the subject's verb)
 - **Agent:** The person who will do the action.
 - **Causative verb:** The agent's verb.
 - **Object:** The thing to be acted upon by the agent.
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- **Sujeto:** La persona que inicia la acción.
 - **Verbo principal** (o funcional): El verbo que se conjuga (el verbo del sujeto).
 - **Agente:** La persona que realizará la acción.
 - **Verbo causativo:** El verbo del agente.
 - **Objeto:** La cosa sobre la que el agente realiza la acción.



GENERAL RULES

- There are 3 common structures used.
- Some main verbs can be used in several structures, others are specific to that structure.
- Causatives and permissives do not use subordinate clauses.

Hay tres estructuras comunes que se utilizan.

- Algunos verbos principales pueden usarse en varias estructuras, mientras que otros son específicos de una sola.
- Las formas causativas y permisivas no utilizan oraciones subordinadas.

STRUCTURES

CAUSATIVE I

Subject

Main Verb

Object

Causative Verb

Agent

I have my taxes done (by an accountant).

- Passive voice
- Causative verb is in participle form
- Agent not always necessary, “by” precedes

CAUSATIVE 2

Subject

Main Verb

Agent

Causative Verb

Object

I have an accountant do my taxes.

- Active voice.
- Causative verb is in simple form.
- Agent is direct object.

CAUSATIVE 3



I get an accountant to do my taxes.

- Active voice.
- Causative verb is in infinitive form.
- Agent is direct object.

COMMON MAIN VERBS

Causative 1	Causative 2	Causative 3
have	have	get
get	let	persuade
want	make	allow
would like	help	want
		would like
CV is in participle form	CV is in simple form	CV in infinitive form